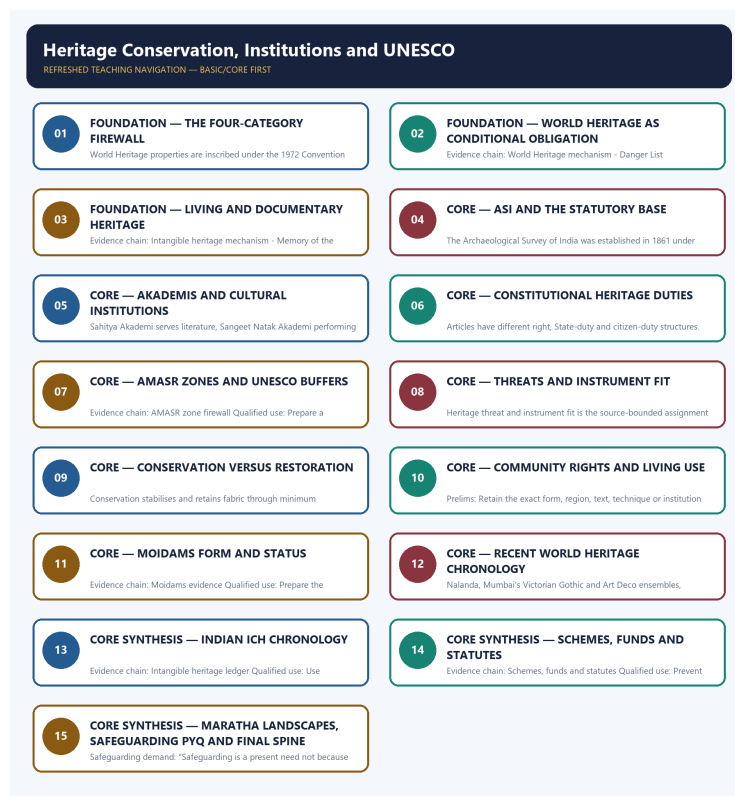


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Heritage Conservation, Institutions and UNESCO - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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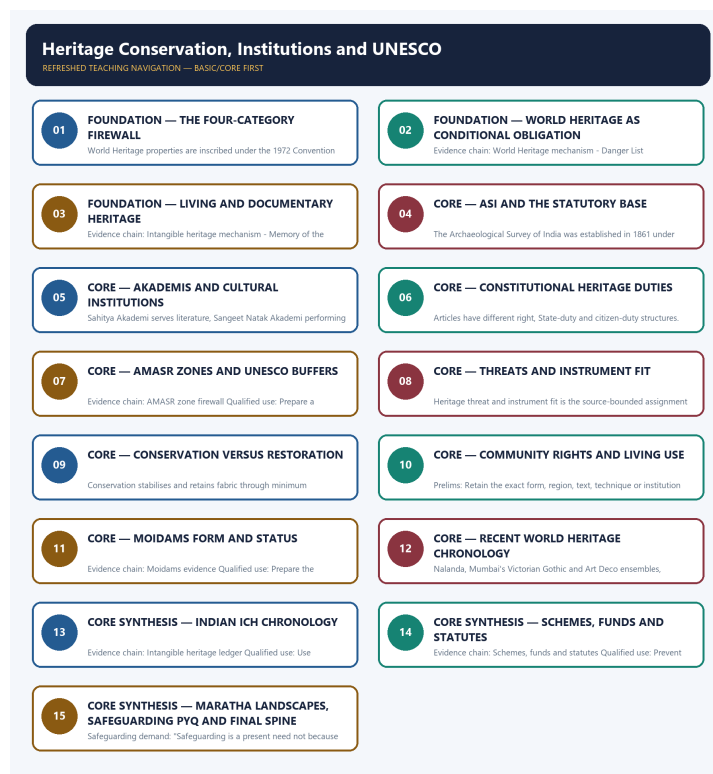
Heritage Conservation, Institutions and UNESCO - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-01. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-01.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The available OCR-searchable Nitin Singhanian Indian Art and Culture PDF was retained as a supplementary source; no unsupported page precision, quotation or dynamic status was imported from it.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** The verified direct Mains route is 2018 GS-I on safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need. The objective routes are 2023 colonial archaeologists, 2024 the 2023 inscriptions of Santiniketan and the Hoysala ensembles, and provisional 2026 Moidams; objective answer letters are not inferred.
- **Live-link boundary:** UNESCO's property page and the Ministry of Culture announcement were fetched on 2026-09-01. They describe the Maratha Military Landscapes as a serial network of twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, and the Ministry page records the 2025 inscription as India's forty-fourth World Heritage entry. The package uses the named property, components and strategic-landscape logic; no later count or conservation outcome is inferred.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - THE FOUR-CATEGORY FIREWALL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Four-category firewall - World Heritage mechanism - Intangible heritage mechanism - Memory of the World mechanism - GI is domestic IP Qualified use: Prevent the most frequent heritage-status error.

Technical definition: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Four-category firewall - World Heritage mechanism - Intangible heritage mechanism - Memory of the World mechanism - GI is domestic IP Qualified use: Prevent the most frequent heritage-status error.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- The four-category firewall
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- World Heritage
- Intangible Cultural Heritage

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The four-category firewall, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use World Heritage for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE FOUR-CATEGORY FIREWALL

01. Four-category firewall

|

v

02. World Heritage mechanism

|

v

03. Intangible heritage mechanism

|

v

04. Memory of the World mechanism

|

v

05. GI is domestic IP

BOUNDARY -> Four systems protect different cultural objects.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies.
- World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.
- The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.
- Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management.
- A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Four systems protect different cultural objects.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to The four-category firewall.
- **Mains:** Prevent the most frequent heritage-status error.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Four-category firewall -> World Heritage mechanism -> Intangible heritage mechanism -> Memory of the World mechanism -> GI is domestic IP
- **Qualified use:** Prevent the most frequent heritage-status error.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE FOUR-CATEGORY FIREWALL

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The four-category firewall

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • The four-category firewall • Evidence chain • Qualified use • World Heritage • Intangible Cultural Heritage

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Four-category firewall - World Heritage mechanism - Intangible heritage mechanism - Memory of the World mechanism - GI is domestic IP Qualified use: Prevent the most frequent heritage-status error.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - WORLD HERITAGE AS CONDITIONAL OBLIGATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: World Heritage mechanism - Danger List conditionality Qualified use: Evaluate benefit, duty and Danger List leverage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- World Heritage as conditional obligation
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- World Heritage properties
- World Heritage

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define World Heritage as conditional obligation, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use World Heritage properties for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WORLD HERITAGE AS CONDITIONAL OBLIGATION

01. World Heritage mechanism

|
v

02. Danger List conditionality

BOUNDARY -> Inscription does not transfer sovereignty or guarantee permanence.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.
- Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Inscription does not transfer sovereignty or guarantee permanence.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to World Heritage as conditional obligation.

- **Mains:** Evaluate benefit, duty and Danger List leverage.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** World Heritage mechanism -> Danger List conditionality
- **Qualified use:** Evaluate benefit, duty and Danger List leverage.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - WORLD HERITAGE AS CONDITIONAL OBLIGATION

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - World Heritage as conditional obligation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • World Heritage as conditional obligation • Evidence chain • Qualified use
• World Heritage properties • World Heritage

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: World Heritage mechanism - Danger List conditionality
Qualified use: Evaluate benefit, duty and Danger List leverage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Inscription does not transfer sovereignty or guarantee permanence.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - LIVING AND DOCUMENTARY HERITAGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Intangible heritage mechanism - Memory of the World mechanism Qualified use: Compare ICH and Memory of the World.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Living**
- **documentary heritage**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Convention**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Living, connect documentary heritage with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

LIVING AND DOCUMENTARY HERITAGE

01. Intangible heritage mechanism

|
v

02. Memory of the World mechanism

BOUNDARY -> Recognition, custody and transmission remain different tasks.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.
- Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Recognition, custody and transmission remain different tasks.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Living and documentary heritage.
- **Mains:** Compare ICH and Memory of the World.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Intangible heritage mechanism -> Memory of the World mechanism
- **Qualified use:** Compare ICH and Memory of the World.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - LIVING AND DOCUMENTARY HERITAGE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Living and documentary heritage

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Living • documentary heritage • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Convention

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Intangible heritage mechanism - Memory of the World mechanism
Qualified use: Compare ICH and Memory of the World.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that the 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List...

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

SESSION 4 - CORE - ASI AND THE STATUTORY BASE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: ASI and its statutes Qualified use: Name the monument-and-antiquities owner precisely.

Technical definition: The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: ASI and its statutes Qualified use: Name the monument-and-antiquities owner precisely.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- ASI
- the statutory base
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The Archaeological Survey
- India

How to use them: Frame the answer through ASI; define the statutory base, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The Archaeological Survey for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ASI AND THE STATUTORY BASE

01. ASI and its statutes

BOUNDARY -> Institutional founding and statutory mandate answer different questions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Institutional founding and statutory mandate answer different questions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to ASI and the statutory base.
- **Mains:** Name the monument-and-antiquities owner precisely.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** ASI and its statutes
- **Qualified use:** Name the monument-and-antiquities owner precisely.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - ASI AND THE STATUTORY BASE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - ASI and the statutory base

|

v

EXACT TERMS: ASI · the statutory base · Evidence chain · Qualified use · The Archaeological Survey
· India

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that ASI and its statutes Qualified use.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: ASI and its statutes Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: ASI and its statutes Qualified use: Name the monument-and-antiquities owner precisely.

SESSION 5 - CORE - AKADEMIS AND CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Akademi mandate map - Documentary and research institutions
Qualified use: Build an institution-by-function map.

Technical definition: Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Akademis**
- **cultural institutions**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Sahitya Akademi**
- **Sangeet Natak Akademi**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Akademis; define cultural institutions, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Sahitya Akademi for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

AKADEMIS AND CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS

01. Akademi mandate map

|
v

02. Documentary and research institutions

BOUNDARY -> Overlapping projects do not erase primary mandates.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.
- The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Overlapping projects do not erase primary mandates.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Akademis and cultural institutions.
- **Mains:** Build an institution-by-function map.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Akademi mandate map -> Documentary and research institutions
- **Qualified use:** Build an institution-by-function map.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - AKADEMIS AND CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Akademis and cultural institutions

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Akademis · cultural institutions · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Sahitya Akademi · Sangeet Natak Akademi

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Akademi mandate map - Documentary and research institutions
Qualified use: Build an institution-by-function map.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Overlapping projects do not erase primary mandates.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.

SESSION 6 - CORE - CONSTITUTIONAL HERITAGE DUTIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Constitutional heritage frame Qualified use: Give the domestic normative frame.

Technical definition: Articles have different right, State-duty and citizen-duty structures.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Constitutional heritage frame Qualified use: Give the domestic normative frame.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Constitutional heritage duties
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Article 29
- Article 49
- Article 51A

How to use them: Frame the answer through Constitutional heritage duties; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Article 29 to explain the mechanism, and use Article 49 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CONSTITUTIONAL HERITAGE DUTIES

01. Constitutional heritage frame

BOUNDARY -> Articles have different right, State-duty and citizen-duty structures.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Articles have different right, State-duty and citizen-duty structures.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Constitutional heritage duties.
- **Mains:** Give the domestic normative frame.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Constitutional heritage frame
- **Qualified use:** Give the domestic normative frame.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CONSTITUTIONAL HERITAGE DUTIES

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Constitutional heritage duties



EXACT TERMS: Constitutional heritage duties · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Article 29 · Article 49 · Article 51A



MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Articles have different right, State-duty and citizen-duty structures.



CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that evidence chain: Constitutional heritage frame Qualified use: Give the domestic normative frame.



UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: evidence chain: Constitutional heritage frame Qualified use: Give the domestic normative frame.



ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Constitutional heritage frame Qualified use: Give the domestic normative frame.

SESSION 7 - CORE - AMASR ZONES AND UNESCO BUFFERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: AMASR zone firewall Qualified use: Prepare a close-option legal distinction.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- AMASR zones
- UNESCO buffers
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Indian
- UNESCO

How to use them: Frame the answer through AMASR zones; define UNESCO buffers, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Indian for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

AMASR ZONES AND UNESCO BUFFERS

01. AMASR zone firewall

BOUNDARY -> Domestic statutory distance is not an international management boundary.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Domestic statutory distance is not an international management boundary.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to AMASR zones and UNESCO buffers.
- **Mains:** Prepare a close-option legal distinction.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** AMASR zone firewall
- **Qualified use:** Prepare a close-option legal distinction.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - AMASR ZONES AND UNESCO BUFFERS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - AMASR zones and UNESCO buffers

|

v

EXACT TERMS: AMASR zones · UNESCO buffers · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Indian · UNESCO

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: AMASR zone firewall Qualified use: Prepare a close-option legal distinction.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Domestic statutory distance is not an international management boundary.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

SESSION 8 - CORE - THREATS AND INSTRUMENT FIT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Heritage threats require different responses because visitor pressure, construction, climate, illicit trade and transmission loss damage different cultural assets.

Technical definition: Heritage threat and instrument fit is the source-bounded assignment of each documented damage mechanism to the competent statute, conservation method, archive, cultural institution, funding tool or livelihood intervention.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Heritage policy succeeds when the response fits the mechanism of loss rather than when every institution is listed.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- visitor load
- urban construction
- climate pressure
- illicit trade
- transmission loss
- instrument fit

How to use them: Map visitor load to access management, urban construction and climate pressure to regulation and monitoring, illicit trade to antiquities law, and transmission loss to practitioner support; then qualify the instrument fit through capacity and community rights.

VISUAL FIRST

THREATS AND INSTRUMENT FIT

01. Threat-to-instrument matching

BOUNDARY -> Each damage mechanism needs a matched response.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Each damage mechanism needs a matched response.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Threats and instrument fit.
- **Mains:** Convert a generic threat list into policy analysis.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Threat-to-instrument matching
- **Qualified use:** Convert a generic threat list into policy analysis.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THREATS AND INSTRUMENT FIT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Threats and instrument fit

|

v

EXACT TERMS: visitor load · urban construction · climate pressure · illicit trade · transmission loss · instrument fit

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Threat-to-instrument matching Qualified use: Convert a generic threat list into policy analysis.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that convert a generic threat list into policy analysis.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: convert a generic threat list into policy analysis.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Heritage policy succeeds when the response fits the mechanism of loss rather than when every institution is listed.

SESSION 9 - CORE - CONSERVATION VERSUS RESTORATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Conservation and restoration Qualified use: Explain authenticity and reversibility.

Technical definition: Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Conservation and restoration Qualified use: Explain authenticity and reversibility.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Conservation versus restoration
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Conservation
- Qualified
- CORE - Conservation versus restoration

How to use them: Frame the answer through Conservation versus restoration; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Conservation to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CONSERVATION VERSUS RESTORATION

01. Conservation and restoration

BOUNDARY -> Restoring an earlier state always selects and may erase a layer.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Restoring an earlier state always selects and may erase a layer.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Conservation versus restoration.
- **Mains:** Explain authenticity and reversibility.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Conservation and restoration
- **Qualified use:** Explain authenticity and reversibility.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CONSERVATION VERSUS RESTORATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Conservation versus restoration

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Conservation versus restoration · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Conservation · Qualified · CORE - Conservation versus restoration

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Conservation and restoration Qualified use: Explain authenticity and reversibility.

SESSION 10 - CORE - COMMUNITY RIGHTS AND LIVING USE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Community rights in living sites Qualified use: Balance fabric, worship and livelihood.

Technical definition: Prelims: Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Community rights and living use.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Community rights in living sites Qualified use: Balance fabric, worship and livelihood.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Community rights
- living use
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood
- Active

How to use them: Frame the answer through Community rights; define living use, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

COMMUNITY RIGHTS AND LIVING USE

01. Community rights in living sites

BOUNDARY -> Access and ritual are conservation variables, not noise.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Access and ritual are conservation variables, not noise.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Community rights and living use.
- **Mains:** Balance fabric, worship and livelihood.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Community rights in living sites
- **Qualified use:** Balance fabric, worship and livelihood.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - COMMUNITY RIGHTS AND LIVING USE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Community rights and living use

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Community rights · living use · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood · Active

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Prelims: Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Community rights and living use.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Access and ritual are conservation variables, not noise.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Community rights in living sites Qualified use: Balance fabric, worship and livelihood.

SESSION 11 - CORE - MOIDAMS FORM AND STATUS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Moidams evidence Qualified use: Prepare the provisional 2026 route.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Moidams form**

- **status**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Moidams at Charaideo**
- **Moidams**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Moidams form; define status, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Moidams at Charaideo for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MOIDAMS FORM AND STATUS

01. Moidams evidence

BOUNDARY -> Funerary architecture and political history must remain distinct.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Funerary architecture and political history must remain distinct.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Moidams form and status.
- **Mains:** Prepare the provisional 2026 route.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Moidams evidence
- **Qualified use:** Prepare the provisional 2026 route.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - MOIDAMS FORM AND STATUS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Moidams form and status

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Moidams form • status • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Moidams at Charaideo • Moidams

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Moidams evidence Qualified use: Prepare the provisional 2026 route.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Funerary architecture and political history must remain distinct.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: evidence chain: Moidams evidence Qualified use: Prepare the provisional 2026 route.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

SESSION 12 - CORE - RECENT WORLD HERITAGE CHRONOLOGY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Recent World Heritage ledger Qualified use: Retain property and serial-component discipline.

Technical definition: Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Recent World Heritage ledger Qualified use: Retain property and serial-component discipline.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Recent World Heritage chronology
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Nalanda
- Mumbai's Victorian Gothic
- 2016-2025

How to use them: Frame the answer through Recent World Heritage chronology; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Nalanda to explain the mechanism, and use Mumbai's Victorian Gothic for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

RECENT WORLD HERITAGE CHRONOLOGY

01. Recent World Heritage ledger

BOUNDARY -> A dated partial ledger is not a national total.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A dated partial ledger is not a national total.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Recent World Heritage chronology.
- **Mains:** Retain property and serial-component discipline.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Recent World Heritage ledger
- **Qualified use:** Retain property and serial-component discipline.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - RECENT WORLD HERITAGE CHRONOLOGY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Recent World Heritage chronology

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Recent World Heritage chronology · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Nalanda · Mumbai's Victorian Gothic · 2016-2025

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A dated partial ledger is not a national total.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: recent World Heritage ledger Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Recent World Heritage ledger Qualified use: Retain property and serial-component discipline.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - INDIAN ICH CHRONOLOGY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Intangible heritage ledger Qualified use: Use inscription years rather than stale totals.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Indian ICH chronology
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Indian ICH
- Deepavali

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Indian ICH chronology, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Indian ICH for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

INDIAN ICH CHRONOLOGY

01. Intangible heritage ledger

BOUNDARY -> Nowruz is multinational and latest-item answers are date-bound.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Nowruz is multinational and latest-item answers are date-bound.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Indian ICH chronology.
- **Mains:** Use inscription years rather than stale totals.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Intangible heritage ledger
- **Qualified use:** Use inscription years rather than stale totals.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - INDIAN ICH CHRONOLOGY

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Indian ICH chronology

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • Indian ICH chronology • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Indian ICH • Deepavali

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Intangible heritage ledger Qualified use: Use inscription years rather than stale totals.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Nowruz is multinational and latest-item answers are date-bound.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Use inscription years rather than stale totals.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - SCHEMES, FUNDS AND STATUTES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Schemes, funds and statutes Qualified use: Prevent institutional category errors.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Schemes**
- **funds**
- **statutes**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Schemes, connect funds with statutes to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCHEMES, FUNDS AND STATUTES

01. Schemes, funds and statutes

BOUNDARY -> Amenities, finance, regulation and conservation are different functions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Amenities, finance, regulation and conservation are different functions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Schemes, funds and statutes.
- **Mains:** Prevent institutional category errors.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Schemes, funds and statutes
- **Qualified use:** Prevent institutional category errors.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - SCHEMES, FUNDS AND STATUTES

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Schemes, funds and statutes

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • Schemes • funds • statutes • Evidence chain • Qualified use

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Schemes, funds and statutes Qualified use: Prevent institutional category errors.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Amenities, finance, regulation and conservation are different functions.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: schemes, funds and statutes Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - MARATHA LANDSCAPES, SAFEGUARDING PYQ AND FINAL SPINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred.

Technical definition: Safeguarding demand: "Safeguarding is a present need not because heritage is old but because the specific pressures on it - visitor load, urban encroachment, climate action on fabric and the failure of transmission in living traditions - are current and measurable, and each requires a different instrument." UNESCO evaluation: "World Heritage status is best judged as a conditional obligation with reputational leverage: it attracts attention, funding and visitors, and it simultaneously raises the standard against which failure is measured - India's own Danger-List entries and removals prove both halves." Institutional demand: "India does not lack heritage institutions; it lacks the alignment of instrument, capacity and community consent, and the credible reform agenda is about that alignment rather than about new bodies."

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

728-729). **FACT:** As of July 2025 (per the book), no Indian site is on the Danger List. **CURRENT:** Recent inscription with criteria: UNESCO inscribed Moidams - the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty at Charaideo on 26 July of mound-covered vaults created from the thirteenth to nineteenth centuries, recognised under criteria (iii) and (iv). **WRONG:** Moidams are not ordinary earthen tumuli: UNESCO describes a mound over a hollow vault, with a shrine and octagonal wall, within a continuing funerary and ancestor-worship landscape. **CURRENT:** Most recent property: the Maratha Military Landscapes of India (2025) is India's 44th, a serial inscription. **WRONG:** Do not repeat "43rd" without noting the current 44th. **CURRENT:** Living-practice recognition: Deepavali (2025) as the 16th Representative List element; Garba of Gujarat (2023); Kutiyattam (2008). **CURRENT:** Estate scale: ASI's live Monuments page states it protects and maintains 3,679 centrally protected monuments and archaeological sites (accessed 21 July 2026) - cite the live figure with its access date. **ANALYSIS:** Sovereignty rule: inscription confers international recognition and Convention-based protections; ownership, management and legal jurisdiction remain with India and its own institutions (ASI/AMASR).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Maratha Landscapes**
- **safeguarding PYQ**
- **final spine**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Maratha Landscapes, connect safeguarding PYQ with final spine to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MARATHA LANDSCAPES, SAFEGUARDING PYQ AND FINAL SPINE

01. Maratha Military Landscapes current link

|
v

02. Verified heritage PYQ routes

BOUNDARY -> Current recognition must be tied to a direct dated source.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.
- The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Current recognition must be tied to a direct dated source.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact form, region, text, technique or institution attached to Maratha Landscapes, safeguarding PYQ and final spine.
- **Mains:** Close with the direct 2018 demand and current UNESCO evidence.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Maratha Military Landscapes current link -> Verified heritage PYQ routes
- **Qualified use:** Close with the direct 2018 demand and current UNESCO evidence.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Indian Art & Culture | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:**

Tangible/intangible/documentary heritage categories; ASI, NMMA, SNA, LKA, Sahitya Akademi, IGNCA/archives; AMASR and Antiquities law basics; constitutional culture provisions (Articles 29, 49, 51A(f)). **Grounded in:** Nitin Singhania, *Indian Art and Culture*, PDF pp. 722-738 (UNESCO WHS/ICH), 955-971 (institutions), 983-992 (law/Constitution); 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 3, 9; audited UPSC Mains 2024-2025 GS Paper I (no direct question - capstone/support role); official UNESCO WHC/ICH/Memory of the World and PIB pages (verified 21 July 2026). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap. *Companion:* advanced/14_Heritage-Conservation-Institutions-and-UNESCO.md.

1. Snapshot and syllabus fit

FACT: This is the folder's **capstone topic** - every earlier topic's UNESCO/ institutional/current-status claim routes through this file. **ANALYSIS:** No 2024/ 2025 Mains question tests heritage institutions directly, but this topic underwrites the current-anchor accuracy of every other topic's answer.

2. Essential vocabulary

Term	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: World Heritage Site (WHS)	A property inscribed under the 1972 World Heritage Convention for outstanding cultural, natural or mixed universal value, selected by the 21-member World Heritage Committee (aided by IUCN, ICOMOS, ICCROM) (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 723).
FACT: Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH)	Living "practices, representations, expressions, knowledge, skills" recognised under UNESCO's 2003 Convention through the Representative List, the List of ICH in Need of Urgent Safeguarding, and the Register of Good Safeguarding Practices (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 732-733; UNESCO 2003 Convention mechanisms).
FACT: Memory of the World Register	UNESCO's documentary-heritage register for manuscripts/archives (see topic 11).
FACT: Geographical Indication (GI)	Origin-linked intellectual property under domestic law (see topic 12) - not a UNESCO category at all.
FACT: AMASR Act	The Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958, under which ASI functions, alongside the Antiquities and Art Treasure Act, 1972 (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 956).
FACT: Adarsh Smarak Scheme	ASI's scheme identifying 100 monuments (e.g. Bhimbetka, Hampi, Konark, Elephanta, Mahabalipuram's Shore Temple, Taj Mahal, Humayun's Tomb) for enhanced visitor amenities (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 956).

3. Core classification

FACT: Indian cultural heritage recognition operates across **four distinct, non-interchangeable categories**: World Heritage Sites (tangible/mixed/ natural, 1972 Convention), Intangible Cultural Heritage (living practice, 2003 Convention), Memory of the World Register (documentary heritage), and Geographical Indications (domestic IP law, unrelated to UNESCO). FACT: India's cultural institutions split by domain: **ASI** (monuments/ archaeology), **Sahitya Akademi** (literature), **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (music/dance/drama), **Lalit Kala Akademi** (visual/fine arts), **Anthropological Survey of India** (anthropological research), **National Archives of India** (documentary records), **Asiatic Society** (oriental studies), alongside NMMA, ICCR, CCRT and others (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 955-971).

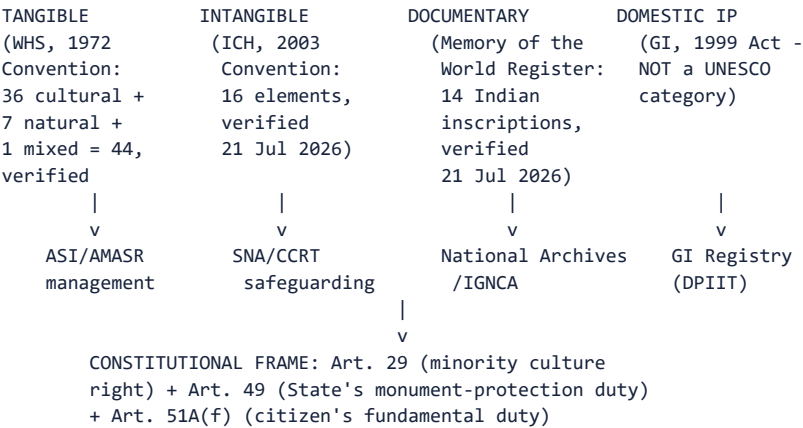
4. Foundation narrative

CURRENT: **UNESCO WHS in India**: as verified 21 July 2026, India has **44 World Heritage properties** - 36 cultural, 7 natural, 1 mixed (Khangchendzonga National Park, the only Indian mixed-category site) (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 723, 727). FACT: No Indian site currently appears on UNESCO's List of World Heritage in Danger (as of July 2025); Manas Wildlife Sanctuary and the Group of Monuments at Hampi were **previously** listed as endangered (ethnic unrest and cable-bridge construction respectively) but have since been removed following conservation improvements (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 728-729). CURRENT: **UNESCO ICH in India**: India has **16 elements** on the Representative List after Deepavali's 2025 inscription; none is currently on the Urgent Safeguarding List (UNESCO ICH India page, verified 21 July 2026). Network membership counts (such as Creative Cities) change independently and should not be mixed with WHS/ICH totals.

FACT: **ASI**: established 1861 under Alexander Cunningham ("father of Indian archaeology" and first Director-General); functions under the AMASR Act, 1958, and the Antiquities and Art Treasure Act, 1972; maintains an Underwater Archaeology Wing and the Adarsh Smarak scheme (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 956-957). FACT: **Sahitya Akademi** (est. 1954): promotes literature in 24 languages (22 Eighth Schedule languages plus English and Rajasthani); awards include the Sahitya Akademi Award, Bhasha Samman, and the Dr. Ananda Coomaraswamy and Premchand Fellowships (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF p. 964). FACT: **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (est. 1952): India's first national performing-arts academy; constituent units include the Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy and Kathak Kendra; parented the National School of Drama (independent since 1975) (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 965-967). FACT: **Lalit Kala Akademi** (est. 1954): national fine-arts academy; runs the National Exhibition of Art and the Triennale-India

(since 1968) (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF p. 967-968). FACT: **Constitutional provisions:** Article 29 protects minority communities' right to conserve their own language/script/ culture; Article 49 obliges the State to protect monuments/objects of national importance from "spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export"; Article 51A(f) is a **Fundamental Duty** requiring every citizen "to value and preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture" (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 984-985).

5. Visual map or comparison table



Category	Governing instrument	India's count (book-period)
FACT: World Heritage Site	1972 Convention	44 (36 cultural + 7 natural + 1 mixed), verified 21 July 2026
FACT: Intangible Cultural Heritage	2003 Convention	16 Representative List elements, verified 21 July 2026
FACT: Memory of the World	UNESCO documentary register	14 Indian International Register inscriptions, verified 21 July 2026
FACT: Geographical Indication	GI Act, 1999 (domestic)	658 goods, July 2025 (topic 12)

Current sequence	Status
Moidams - the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty	India's 43rd WH property, inscribed 2024
Maratha Military Landscapes of India	India's 44th WH property, serial inscription in 2025
Deepavali	India's 16th Representative List ICH element, inscribed 2025
Bhagavadgita and Natyashastra manuscripts	2025 additions taking India's Memory of the World International Register total to 14

FACT: **AMASR spatial trap:** around a centrally protected monument, the first 100 metres are generally a prohibited area and the next 200 metres a regulated area, subject to the statutory/competent-authority framework. These domestic legal zones are not UNESCO buffer zones and must not be conflated with them.

6. Source spine

FACT: *Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 722-738 (UNESCO WHS and ICH chapters), PDF pp. 955-971 (Cultural Institutions in India), PDF pp. 983-985 (Law and Culture/constitutional provisions) - the direct spine for Sections 2-4. ANALYSIS: **Extraction limit recorded:** the book's own WHS list is presented as a wide table whose "Declared in / State" columns are **truncated in the locally held PDF beyond the first row**, so the dated ledger in **§13.8A** was **not** built from that table. It was built from (i) named, individually sourced statements elsewhere in the book (Ramappa 2021 at PDF p. 109; the three Hoysala temples 2023 at PDF p. 104; Pattadakal 1987 at PDF p. 101), and (ii) **UNESCO's own property pages** for Nalanda Mahavihara and the Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas, plus the Government of India's dated announcement for the 2025 Maratha inscription - all read on **13 August 2026**.

7. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests heritage institutions or UNESCO categories as a stand-alone topic. This topic is the **verification layer** for every other topic's current- status claim (e.g. topic 03's Khajuraho 1986 inscription, topic 03's Great Living Chola Temples 1987/2004, topic 09's Garba 2023 ICH inscription).

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: UNESCO inscribed ****Moidams - the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom**

Dynasty **at Charaideo on 26 July 2024**** (India's 43rd WHS). The property is a Tai-Ahom royal necropolis of mound-covered vaults created from the thirteenth to nineteenth centuries and recognised under criteria (iii) and (iv). Political-administrative Ahom history routes to Medieval History topic 08; this file owns funerary form, status and conservation.

- CURRENT: UNESCO records **44 World Heritage properties** in India as verified

21 July 2026, including the **Maratha Military Landscapes of India (2025)** as the most recent addition.

- CURRENT: UNESCO's ICH India page and decision 20.COM 7.b.24 confirm

Deepavali's 2025 inscription, bringing India to **16 Representative List elements** (verified 21 July 2026). FACT: Re-confirmed **13 August 2026** against the **Ministry of Culture** announcement, which dates the decision to **10 December 2025** at the **20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee** held at the **Red Fort, Delhi** - the first session India has hosted - and states that "with Deepavali's inclusion, India now has **16 elements** on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list." FACT: The full dated element ledger is at **§13.8B**.

- CURRENT: ASI's live Monuments page states that it protects and maintains

3,679 centrally protected monuments and archaeological sites (accessed 21 July 2026); cite the live ASI figure with its access date.

9. WRONG: Traps and corrections

- WRONG: World Heritage Site, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the

World, and Geographical Indication are interchangeable "heritage tags." -> Each is governed by a distinct instrument (1972 Convention; 2003 Convention; UNESCO's documentary register; India's domestic GI Act,

1999. with different criteria and a different granting body.

- WRONG: A monument's inclusion in the UNESCO Tentative List means it is

already a World Heritage Site. -> Tentative-list status (e.g. Bishnupur, Mattancherry Palace, Mandu, Sarnath, Sri Harimandir Sahib) is a nomination step, not an inscription.

- WRONG: Any Indian site currently sits on the List of World Heritage in

Danger. -> As of July 2025 (per the book), no Indian site is on this list; Manas and Hampi were **previously** listed but have since been removed.

- WRONG: Moidams are ordinary earthen tumuli without a built or ritual system.

-> UNESCO describes a mound over a hollow vault, a shrine and octagonal wall within a continuing Tai-Ahom funerary and ancestor-worship landscape.

- WRONG: UNESCO inscription transfers ownership of a site or object to

UNESCO. -> Inscription confers international recognition and Convention-based protections; ownership, management and legal jurisdiction remain with the State Party (India) and its own institutions (ASI/AMASR).

- WRONG: UNESCO World Heritage buffer zones and AMASR prohibited/regulated

areas are identical. -> They arise from different legal instruments and may have different mapped boundaries.

- WRONG: Natyashastra's 2025 Memory of the World inscription is unverified. ->

UNESCO/UN India announced both Bhagavadgita and Natyashastra additions; distinguish the manuscripts' inscription year from the texts' composition histories.

- FACT: **Local PYQ trap**: CSE 2024's "latest inclusion" question was

time-bound (Garba then). Deepavali's 2025 inscription changes a live answer; always read the question's date.

- **WRONG:** A repatriation of an artefact can be assumed or inferred without a dated official announcement. -> Never state that a specific object has been repatriated unless a dated official source names the object, the receiving institution and its provenance.

10. Mains framework

1. Name the precise heritage category (WHS/ICH/Memory of the World/GI) before making any claim about "UNESCO recognition."
2. Cite the exact, dated figure (with its access/verification date) for any count - never an undated round number.
3. Distinguish Tentative List status from actual inscription.
4. Name the specific Indian institution (ASI, SNA, LKA, Sahitya Akademi, etc.) with its precise mandate rather than a generic "cultural body."
5. Close with the constitutional frame (Articles 29, 49, 51A(f)) where a question invites a legal/rights dimension.

11. Boundaries with other subjects

- **WRONG:** **Polity owns** the detailed constitutional/fundamental-rights doctrine and judicial interpretation of Articles 29, 49 and 51A(f) in full legal depth. This file owns their **cultural-heritage application**.
- **WRONG:** **Economy owns** heritage tourism's economic-sectoral analysis in depth. This file owns the **institutional and conservation architecture**.
- **WRONG:** **Current Affairs owns** day-to-day event chronology beyond dated heritage anchors.
- **FACT:** This topic is the cross-cutting verification layer for **every** topic in this folder (01-13).

12. Companion links

- **FACT:** Advanced companion: `advanced/14_Heritage-Conservation-Institutions-and-UNESCO.md`.
- **FACT:** `00_Master-Framework.md` Sections 3 and 9 - the WHS/ICH/Memory of the World/GI category table and the official-source ledger, both fully developed here.
- **ANALYSIS:** **Cross-links:** every topic in this folder routes its current-status claims through this file; see especially topic 03 (Khajuraho/Chola UNESCO status), topic 09 (Garba ICH status), topic 11 (Memory of the World), topic 12 (GI Registry).

13. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Core-sufficiency note. This is the folder's capstone and the owner of every conservation, institution and heritage-status demand - the demand family most likely to appear in an unfamiliar wording, because it is where art and culture meets governance. This section makes basic/14 sufficient for those demands without advanced/14.

13.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

Core routing supersedes older advanced/ pointers (final pass, 2026-08-13). The controlling ledger `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md` routes the demand below to advanced/14. It is answerable **from this Core file alone**, and Core is the owner of record.

Year	Verbatim routed demand	Directive · marks	FACT: Core section that answers it
2018	Safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need	Discuss · 10 · 150 words	§§13.4, 13.5, 13.6, 13.7, 13.8, 13.8A, 13.8B, 13.8C, with §13.2's instrument-fit thesis and §13.10's safeguarding verdict

ANALYSIS: Executable 10-mark route for the 2018 wording. The directive is "discuss," and the statement asserts a **present need** - so marks come from proving *currency* and *specificity*, not from praising heritage. Thesis (§13.2 instrument-fit: protection fails from **instrument mismatch**, not from absent law) -> **the four-category firewall** (§13.4: WHS, ICH, MoW, GI - four instruments, four bodies, four legal bases) -> **named threats with mechanisms** (§13.7) -> **named instruments matched to them**: AMASR for fabric, the **akademis** for transmission, **NMM/National Archives** for documents, **GI** for craft names, the **NCF** for funding and **Adopt a Heritage/Monument Mitras** for amenities (§§13.5, 13.8C) -> **a dated current anchor** (Deepavali's ICH inscription, **10 December 2025**, §13.8B; the Maratha Military Landscapes, **2025**, §13.8A) -> **the gap** (capacity thesis; the **Hall of Nations** demolished in 2017 because 20th-century architecture falls outside the AMASR antiquity threshold, topic 05) -> verdict (§13.10). **ANALYSIS: The strongest single move** is the living-heritage point: India has **16 ICH elements and none on the Urgent Safeguarding List**, which shows recognition is running ahead of any demonstrated transmission crisis - recognition is not safeguarding.

13.1 Directive and demand map

If the question says	It is really testing	Do NOT write
<i>Safeguarding India's art heritage is a present need. Discuss</i>	Threat diagnosis -> instrument -> institution -> gap -> realistic remedy	A list of threats and a plea
<i>Conservation versus restoration</i>	Minimum intervention and reversibility versus reconstruction, and the authenticity question	Using the two words interchangeably
<i>Evaluate UNESCO World Heritage status for India</i>	Benefits and trade-offs, plus conditionality (Danger List)	"WHS status brings prestige and tourism"
<i>Distinguish the heritage categories</i>	Four instruments, four governing frameworks, four granting bodies	Calling GI a UNESCO tag
<i>Institutional architecture for culture</i>	Named body + precise mandate + statutory basis	"Various cultural bodies exist"
<i>Community rights in heritage management</i>	Living heritage, worship, access, livelihood and displacement	Treating monuments as empty objects
<i>Tourism, urbanisation, disaster and climate pressure on heritage</i>	Specific mechanisms of damage and specific regulatory responses	Generic "development versus environment"
<i>Repatriation of cultural objects</i>	Provenance, legal instruments and evidentiary discipline	Asserting an undated repatriation

13.2 Qualified thesis options

- **ANALYSIS: Instrument-fit thesis:** "Heritage protection fails most often not from absent law but from instrument mismatch - a monument statute protects fabric, a living tradition needs transmission support, a document needs custody and digitisation, and a craft name needs intellectual property; using the wrong instrument produces protection on paper and loss in practice."
- **ANALYSIS: Conditionality thesis:** "World Heritage status is conditional, not permanent: the Danger List mechanism exists, and India's own record shows both listing and de-listing after documented improvement - which makes inscription the start of an obligation rather than the end of a process."
- **ANALYSIS: Capacity thesis:** "India's heritage architecture is institutionally rich and capacity-constrained: a large centrally protected estate, several specialised academies and a constitutional duty coexist with limited conservation manpower, funding and enforcement reach."
- **ANALYSIS: Living-heritage thesis:** "Where a monument is still worshipped or a

practice still performed, conservation cannot be separated from the community that sustains it - access, ritual use and livelihood are conservation variables, not obstacles to it."

- ANALYSIS: **Authenticity thesis**: "Restoration always makes an interpretive

choice about which period to present, which is why documented, reversible, minimum intervention is the defensible default and full reconstruction the exception."

13.3 Mark-scaled structures

Marks	Structure
10	Thesis -> the precise category or instrument -> two named institutions/provisions -> one limitation -> verdict
10 (the 2018 safeguarding route)	Run §13.0's eight-step route: instrument-fit thesis -> four-category firewall -> named threats with mechanisms -> instruments matched to threats (AMASR, akademis, NMM, GI, NCF, Adopt a Heritage) -> a dated current anchor -> the capacity/coverage gap -> verdict
10/15 (ICH and living heritage)	Run §13.8B : define ICH against the 2003 Convention's three lists -> four or five dated elements across different domains (Kutiyattam 2008 performing arts, Thatheras 2014 craft, Yoga 2016 knowledge practice, Kumbh Mela 2017 social practice, Deepavali 2025 festival) -> the Nowruz multinational discriminator -> no Indian element on the Urgent Safeguarding List and none on the Register of Good Safeguarding Practices -> recognition-is-not-safeguarding verdict
15	Thesis -> four-category firewall -> statutory and constitutional frame -> two named cases (e.g. Danger List, Moidams) -> capacity or community limitation -> verdict
20	All of the above -> plus the threat taxonomy -> conservation-versus-restoration analysis -> community rights and tourism trade-off -> documentation/repatriation discipline -> dated status anchors -> verdict answering the exact wording

13.4 Evidence bank A - the four-category firewall (the highest-frequency error)

Category	Governing instrument	Granting body	India's status (verified 21 July 2026)
World Heritage Site	1972 World Heritage Convention	World Heritage Committee (21 members, advised by IUCN, ICOMOS, ICCROM)	CURRENT: 44 properties - 36 cultural, 7 natural, 1 mixed (Khangchendzonga)
Intangible Cultural Heritage	2003 Convention (Representative List; Urgent Safeguarding List; Register of Good Safeguarding Practices)	UNESCO ICH intergovernmental committee	CURRENT: 16 Representative List elements ; none currently on the Urgent Safeguarding List
Memory of the World	UNESCO documentary-heritage register	UNESCO MoW programme	CURRENT: 14 International Register inscriptions (topic 11)
Geographical Indication	GI of Goods (Registration & Protection) Act, 1999 - domestic law, not UNESCO	GI Registry, Chennai (DPIIT)	658 goods, July 2025 (topic 12)

WRONG: **Two errors this table prevents**: treating the four as interchangeable "heritage tags," and treating **Tentative List** entries (e.g. Bishnupur, Mattancherry Palace, Mandu, Sarnath, Sri Harimandir Sahib) as inscriptions.

13.5 Evidence bank B - institutions with precise mandates

Institution	FACT: Mandate and detail
ASI	Established 1861 under Alexander Cunningham, "father of Indian archaeology" and first Director-General; functions under the AMASR Act, 1958 and the Antiquities and Art Treasure Act, 1972 ; maintains an Underwater Archaeology Wing and the Adarsh Smarak scheme identifying 100 monuments (Bhimbetka, Hampi, Konark, Elephanta, the Shore Temple, the Taj Mahal, Humayun's Tomb) for enhanced visitor amenities (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 956-957)
Sahitya Akademi (1954)	Literature in 24 languages (22 Eighth Schedule plus English and Rajasthani); Sahitya Akademi Award, Bhasha Samman, and the Dr Ananda Coomaraswamy and Premchand Fellowships (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 964)
Sangeet Natak Akademi (1952)	India's first national performing-arts academy; constituent units include the Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy and Kathak Kendra; parented the National School of Drama, independent since 1975 (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 965-967)
Lalit Kala Akademi (1954)	National fine-arts academy; National Exhibition of Art; Triennale-India since 1968 (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 967-968)
NMMA, IGNC, National Archives, National Mission for Manuscripts, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR, CCRT	Monument/antiquity documentation, arts research, documentary records, manuscript documentation and digitisation, anthropological research, oriental studies, cultural relations and cultural-resource training respectively

WRONG: **Never treat these as interchangeable.** A performing-arts safeguarding question routes to SNA, a manuscript question to NMM/National Archives, a monument question to ASI - naming the wrong body is a substantive error.

13.6 Evidence bank C - legal and constitutional frame

- FACT: **AMASR spatial rule:** around a centrally protected monument, the first **100 metres** are generally a prohibited area and the next **200 metres** a regulated area, subject to the statutory/competent-authority framework. WRONG: These domestic legal zones are **not** UNESCO buffer zones, which are mapped through nomination and management documents - never substitute one for the other.
- FACT: **Article 29** protects minority communities' right to conserve their own language, script and culture.
- FACT: **Article 49** obliges the State to protect monuments and objects of national importance from "spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export" - the exact verbs are quotable and cover both damage **and** illicit export.
- FACT: **Article 51A(f)** is a **Fundamental Duty** on every citizen "to value and preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture."
- ANALYSIS: Doctrine and judicial interpretation belong to Polity; this file uses the provisions as the constitutional anchor of a cultural answer.

13.7 Evidence bank D - threats, mechanisms and responses

Pressure	Mechanism of damage	Response available in Core
Tourism/visitor load	Abrasion, moisture and pollutant load, informal commercial encroachment, especially at open unwallled sites (topic 03's Khajuraho terraces)	Carrying-capacity management, Adarsh Smarak amenity provision, regulated access
Urbanisation and construction	Encroachment into prohibited/regulated areas; vibration; altered drainage and setting	AMASR 100 m/200 m regime and competent-authority permissions
Environment and climate	FACT: Rainfall, erosion and vegetation growth are recorded management pressures at the Moidams property; damp, biological growth and salt action affect murals and masonry generally	Site-specific conservation planning; documented monitoring
Disaster	Seismic, flood and fire risk to fabric and to archives/manuscripts	Documentation and digitisation as risk transfer (NMM, National Archives)
Neglect and material loss	Loss of traditional repair skills, unsuitable modern materials	Trained conservation manpower; reversible minimum intervention
Illicit trade	Removal and export of antiquities	Antiquities and Art Treasure Act, 1972; Article 49's export prohibition
Loss of transmission (intangible)	Practitioner ageing, income failure, audience loss - e.g. documented puppetry decline (topic 10)	SNA recognition and awards, ICH safeguarding plans, livelihood support

13.8 Evidence bank E - named cases (use these instead of generalities)

- FACT: **Conditionality:** Manas Wildlife Sanctuary and the Group of Monuments

at Hampi were **both** previously placed on the List of World Heritage in Danger - for ethnic unrest and cable-bridge construction respectively - and **both were subsequently removed** after documented conservation improvement (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 728-729). FACT: As of July 2025 (per the book), no Indian site is on the Danger List.

- CURRENT: **Recent inscription with criteria:** UNESCO inscribed **Moidams** - the

Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty **at Charaideo on 26 July 2024, India's 43rd World Heritage property, a Tai-Ahom royal necropolis of mound-covered vaults created from the thirteenth to nineteenth centuries, recognised under criteria (iii) and (iv)****. WRONG: Moidams are not ordinary earthen tumuli: UNESCO describes a mound over a hollow vault, with a shrine and octagonal wall, within a continuing funerary and ancestor-worship landscape.

- CURRENT: **Most recent property:** the **Maratha Military Landscapes of India**

(2025) is India's 44th, a serial inscription. WRONG: Do not repeat "43rd" without noting the current 44th.

- CURRENT: **Living-practice recognition:** **Deepavali** (2025) as the 16th

Representative List element; **Garba of Gujarat** (2023); **Kutiyattam** (2008).

- CURRENT: **Estate scale:** ASI's live Monuments page states it protects and

maintains **3,679 centrally protected monuments and archaeological sites** (accessed 21 July 2026) - cite the live figure **with** its access date.

- ANALYSIS: **Sovereignty rule:** inscription confers international recognition and

Convention-based protections; ownership, management and legal jurisdiction remain with India and its own institutions (ASI/AMASR).

13.8A Evidence bank E+ - the dated Indian World Heritage ledger (2016-2025)

Why this section exists. A hostile review found that this file carried India's **WHS count** and its two most recent properties but no **dated, named ledger**, so cross-links from topics 01, 03 and 05 - Dholavira, the Hoysala ensembles, Ramappa, the Mumbai ensembles - had nowhere authoritative to land. ANALYSIS: **Discipline preserved:** the table below carries **inscription years**, which §13.11 classes as **stable** facts. It carries **no running total**, because totals are dynamic and belong only to §8's dated anchor.

Year	FACT: Official property name	State / UT	Components and notes	Cross-link
2016	Archaeological Site of Nalanda Mahavihara (Nalanda University) at Nalanda	Bihar	FACT: UNESCO's own OUV text describes a 23-hectare site with remains from c. 3rd century BCE , functioning as a monastic-scholastic establishment from the 5th to the 13th century CE , comprising 11 viharas and 14 temples besides smaller shrines and votive structures, and inscribed under criteria (iv) and (vi) (UNESCO property page, verified 13 August 2026); FACT: the local source names Nalanda among the universities built under Pala patronage, with Jagaddala, Odantapuri and Vikramshila (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 120)	Topics 02, 03, 11
2018	Victorian Gothic and Art Deco Ensembles of Mumbai	Maharashtra	An urban ensemble property, not a single monument - the distinction a "which is a WHS" question tests	Topic 05 §13.8
2021	Dholavira: a Harappan City	Gujarat	FACT: The local source records Dholavira as the town "well known for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelising water into connected reservoirs," and as the site of an inscription of ten large-sized Harappan signs (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 166, 183)	Topic 01
2021	Kakatiya Rudreshwara (Ramappa) Temple, Telangana	Telangana	FACT: 13th century AD, Kakatiya, dedicated to Shiva, built in the interest of Recharla Rudra , a general of Ganapati Deva ; sandbox foundation technique and floating stone ; " recognised as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in the year 2021 " (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 108-110)	Topic 03 §13.9A-F
2023	Santiniketan	West Bengal	FACT: The local source ties Nandalal Bose to Santiniketan (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 361)	Topics 05, 07, 11

Year	FACT: Official property name	State / UT	Components and notes	Cross-link
2023	Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas	Karnataka	FACT: A serial property of three 12th-13th century temple complexes: the Channakeshava Temple, Belur ; the Hoysalesvara Temple, Halebidu ; and the Keshava Temple, Somanathapura . UNESCO's OUV cites criteria (i), (ii) and (iv), and identifies the Hoysala style by its stellate sanctum , a circumambulatory platform following the sanctum's shape , a multi-tiered frieze , a thematically arranged sculptural gallery, sculpture over the entire exterior surface, and the legend of Sala killing a tiger ; it also records that the artists' signatures on these temples are "an unusual practice in the Indian subcontinent" (UNESCO property page, verified 13 August 2026). FACT: The local source independently states that "the above three temples were inscribed as UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2023 " (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 104)	FACT: Topic 03 §13.9A-C - this row closes that cross-link
2024	Moidams - the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty	Assam (Charaideo)	CURRENT: Inscribed 26 July 2024 ; a Tai-Ahom royal necropolis of mound-covered vaults created from the 13th to 19th centuries, criteria (iii) and (iv)	§§8, 13.8
2025	Maratha Military Landscapes of India	Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu	CURRENT: A serial inscription; India's most recent property as at this file's verification date	§§8, 13.8; topic 04

ANALYSIS: **Integrity notes that must travel with this ledger.** (i) WRONG: **Do not convert the ledger into a count.** It lists eight inscriptions across 2016-2025, **not** India's total, and several years carry more than one property while other Indian properties fall outside this window. (ii) ANALYSIS: **Component names are the examinable detail** for the two serial properties: the **three** Hoysala temples and the **Maratha** forts. The Hoysala component names above follow **UNESCO**; the local book's table labels the Somanathapura temple "Chennakeshava" where UNESCO says "Keshava," and that variation is recorded, not silently resolved. (iii) FACT: **Extension years are distinct from first-inscription years:** the **Great Living Chola Temples** were inscribed in **1987** and **extended in 2004** - one property, two dates, three complexes (topic 03). (iv) ANALYSIS: **Tentative-List entries must never enter this ledger.** Aihole, Badami and Pattadakal appear together on the Tentative List under "Evolution of Temple Architecture - Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal," but **Pattadakal alone is inscribed, in 1987**; the Thousand Pillar Temple, Warangal Fort and the Kakatiya Kala Thoranam are Tentative-List only (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 99, 101, 108). (v) CURRENT: **Verification:** UNESCO property pages for **Nalanda Mahavihara** and the **Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas** were read directly and the 2025 Maratha inscription cross-checked against the Government of India's own dated announcement, all on **13 August 2026**. Re-verify before citing any of these as current.

13.8B Evidence bank E++ - the dated Indian Intangible Cultural Heritage ledger

Why this section exists. A hostile review found that this file carried India's **ICH count** and a "latest inclusion" caution, but no **dated element-by-element ledger**, so a candidate could not say when Kutiyattam, Yoga or Durga Puja was inscribed, could not order them, and could not answer the recurring "which was the latest inclusion" family except for the single most recent item. ANALYSIS: **Same discipline as §13.8A:** the table carries **inscription years**, which §13.11 classes as **stable**; the **running total** belongs only to §8 with its verification date.

Year	FACT: Official element name (UNESCO Representative List)	Domain	Region / association
2008	Kutiyattam, Sanskrit theatre	Performing arts	Kerala - the folder's oldest Indian inscription (topic 10)
2008	Tradition of Vedic chanting	Oral traditions and expressions	Pan-Indian (topic 11)
2008	Ramlila, the traditional performance of the Ramayana	Performing arts / social practice	North India (topic 10)
2009	Ramman, religious festival and ritual theatre of the Garhwal Himalayas, India	Social practices, rituals and festive events	Uttarakhand (topics 10, 13)
2010	Chhau dance	Performing arts	Odisha, Jharkhand, West Bengal (topic 09)
2010	Kalbelia folk songs and dances of Rajasthan	Performing arts	Rajasthan - FACT: the local source states the inscription year 2010 directly (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 490); the Been/Pungi is its instrument (topics 08, 09)
2010	Mudi yettu, ritual theatre and dance drama of Kerala	Performing arts	Kerala (topic 10)
2012	Buddhist chanting of Ladakh: recitation of sacred Buddhist texts in the trans-Himalayan Ladakh region, Jammu and Kashmir, India	Oral traditions	Ladakh (topics 08, 13)
2013	Sankirtana, ritual singing, drumming and dancing of Manipur	Performing arts	Manipur - FACT: the local source describes it as "ritual singing, drumming and dancing mainly by the Vaishnava community" and links it to Manipuri dance (PDF pp. 443, 474; topics 08, 09)
2014	Traditional brass and copper craft of utensil making among the Thatheras of Jandiala Guru, Punjab, India	Traditional craftsmanship	Punjab - FACT: the folder's only craft ICH element (topic 12)
2016	Yoga	Knowledge and practices concerning nature and the universe	Pan-Indian (topic 13)
2016	Nowruz / Novruz	Social practices and festive events	FACT: A multinational inscription shared with other States Parties - the discriminator a "purely Indian element" question tests
2017	Kumbh Mela	Social practices, rituals and festive events	FACT: Described by the source's own ICH graphic as "an ancient tradition of spiritual significance and the world's largest peaceful gathering" (PDF p. 735; topic 13 §13.7)
2021	Durga Puja in Kolkata	Social practices and festive events	West Bengal - FACT: the source's graphic records "performances, rituals, artistry, and the making of idols and pandals" (PDF p. 735; topics 12, 13)
2023	Garba of Gujarat	Social practices / performing arts	Gujarat - FACT: the local source records the 2023 nomination of Garba and describes it as a Navratri circle dance around a lamp-lit earthen pot, the Garbha deep (PDF p. 482; topic 09)

Year	FACT: Official element name (UNESCO Representative List)	Domain	Region / association
2025	Deepavali	Social practices, rituals and festive events	CURRENT: Inscribed 10 December 2025 , at the 20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee , held at the Red Fort, Delhi - the first time India hosted the session. The nomination was prepared by the Sangeet Natak Akademi under the Ministry of Culture , and Deepavali was among 67 global nominations assessed. Ministry of Culture (culture.gov.in) announcement, verified 13 August 2026

ANALYSIS: **Integrity notes that must travel with this ledger.** (i) FACT: **The list is complete as at the verification date** and comprises **16** elements - but the **total belongs to §8**, which carries the verification date; WRONG: do not write a total from this table alone, and do not carry forward the **15**-element figure printed in the locally held book ("As on August 2025, India has the following 15 items," *Nitin...pdf*, PDF p. 733), which predates the Deepavali inscription. (ii) ANALYSIS: **Nowruz is multinational.** An item asking for elements inscribed **for India or from India alone** is testing this row. (iii) FACT: **India has no element on the List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in Need of Urgent Safeguarding**, and **no Indian practice on the Register of Good Safeguarding Practices** - the source states both explicitly (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 733, 736). Both negatives are examinable and both are safe. (iv) WRONG: **The book's own wide ICH table is clipped in the local PDF** beyond the Kutiyattam row (PDF p. 733), and the substitute graphic on PDF p. 735 is OCR-garbled. The years above therefore rest on the **UNESCO Representative List** and on the **Ministry of Culture's own December 2025 announcement**, cross-checked against the individually sourced local rows (Kalbelia 2010, Garba 2023 nomination, Sankirtana, Kumbh Mela, Durga Puja). ANALYSIS: Re-verify before citing any of these as current. (v) ANALYSIS: **The "latest inclusion" demand is date-bound.** FACT: The reproduced **CSE 2024** item - "Which of the following was the **latest inclusion** in the intangible cultural heritage list of UNESCO? (a) Chhau Dance (b) Durga Puja (c) **Garba Dance** (d) Kumbh Mela" (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF p.

736. - is answered by **Garba**, because at that paper's date Garba

(2023) was the most recent of the four options. ANALYSIS: Today the **latest Indian inclusion is Deepavali (2025)**. Read the question's date before answering; the ledger above makes both answers derivable.

13.8C Evidence bank E+++ - heritage schemes and participation instruments, distinguished from statute

Why this section exists. The same review found that this file owned the **statutes** (AMASR 1958, Antiquities 1972, GI 1999) and the **institutions** (ASI and the akademis) but named **no scheme** - so any question on public-private participation, heritage tourism or community/corporate involvement had nothing to cite. ANALYSIS: **The firewall this bank enforces: a statute** creates protection and offences; an **institution** carries a standing mandate; a **scheme** is an executive programme that can be renamed, restructured or discontinued. Confusing the three is the substantive error here.

Instrument	Type	FACT: What is verified, and by whom	ANALYSIS: Status discipline
Adopt a Heritage - "Apni Dharohar, Apni Pehchaan"	Scheme (participation)	FACT: The local source defines the linked term: " Monument Mitra is the name of a public or private sector company collaborating with the government under the ' Adopt A Heritage ' - ' Apni Dharohar, Apni Pehchaan ' Scheme" (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 988). CURRENT: The scheme was revamped as "Adopt a Heritage 2.0" , with the Ministry of Culture and the ASI as the responsible agencies and adoption confined to visitor amenities under the AMASR Act, 1958 - no structural change to the monument is permitted (Government of India / PIB and ASI material, verified 13 August 2026)	ANALYSIS: Dynamic . The scheme's ministry, its version and the terminology used for adopting agencies have all changed since launch. FACT: Cite it as " Adopt a Heritage , with Monument Mitras as the partner entities," which the local source supports directly; CURRENT: cite the 2.0 revamp and the Culture/ASI locus only with the verification date above. WRONG: Do not state the number of MoUs, the list of adopted monuments, the tenure in years, or a current alternative name for Monument Mitras without re-verification
National Culture Fund (NCF)	Funding mechanism	FACT: Established 1996 under the Charitable Endowments Act, 1890 , as "a distinct funding mechanism for the promotion of art and culture in India," enabling institutions and individuals to support art and culture directly as partners (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 990)	FACT: Stable and fully local-sourced - the safest scheme-type instrument to cite. ANALYSIS: It is a fund , not a conservation authority: it channels money, it does not carry out or regulate conservation
Adarsh Smarak	Scheme (amenities)	FACT: An ASI scheme identifying 100 monuments - including Bhimbetka, Hampi, Konark, Elephanta, the Shore Temple, the Taj Mahal and Humayun's Tomb - for enhanced visitor amenities (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 956-957; §13.5)	FACT: Already in Core and locally sourced. ANALYSIS: It is an amenities scheme, not a protection instrument - protection comes from AMASR
AMASR Act, 1958 · Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972	Statutes	FACT: §13.6; ASI functions under both; the 1972 Act gives the government and Director General power to acquire antiquities for preservation, control their movement, and demand compensation or levy penalties for damage (PDF p. 988)	FACT: Statutes are stable facts; WRONG: do not describe a statute as a "scheme" or vice versa
PRASHAD · HRIDAY	Bounded - not verified here	WRONG: No local source in this folder carries either scheme , and neither was verified against an official page in this pass	WRONG: Do not state their full forms, ministries, launch years, components, funding pattern or current status . ANALYSIS: If a question demands tourism-side heritage programmes by name, write the mechanism - pilgrimage and heritage-city infrastructure delivered through the tourism ministry, distinct from ASI's protection mandate - and say plainly that the named schemes fall outside this folder's verified evidence

- ANALYSIS: **How to use this bank in an answer**. The instrument-fit thesis

(§13.2) becomes concrete here: **AMASR** protects *fabric*; the **NCF** supplies *money*; **Adopt a Heritage** supplies *amenities and partners*; **Adarsh Smarak** upgrades *visitor experience*; the **akademis** sustain *living traditions*; **UNESCO ICH** supplies *international recognition without funding obligations*. A question asking "how should India safeguard its heritage" is answered by matching the threat to the right one of these - not by listing all of them.

- WRONG: **The error this bank exists to prevent**: treating ****Adopt a**

Heritage as a conservation-authority transfer. It is not. Adoption covers amenities, the monument stays under ASI and the AMASR Act**, and no structural or restorative work passes to the partner. An answer that says private companies "were given monuments to maintain" has made a substantive legal error.

13.9 Conservation versus restoration, and community rights

Question	Conservation	Restoration
Aim	Arrest decay, stabilise, retain original fabric	Return the object to a chosen earlier state
Intervention	Minimum, documented, reversible where possible	Substantial, often irreversible
Authenticity risk	Low, but the object continues to age	High - a period must be chosen and later layers may be removed
Worked case	Stabilising a mural surface	ANALYSIS: Brihadeswara's Rajaraja-period paintings carry Nayaka-period superimpositions (topic 07) - restoring "the original" means deciding which century to erase

- ANALYSIS: **Community rights:** Matangeshvara at Khajuraho remains an active site of worship, and Moidams sit within a continuing ancestor-worship landscape. Living use creates rights of access and ritual practice that a purely fabric-centred conservation regime can override; a strong answer names this trade-off instead of assuming the monument is empty.
- ANALYSIS: **Documentation as the least contested instrument:** digitisation and cataloguing (NMM, National Archives, IGNCa) protect informational value even where physical protection fails, and they are the precondition for any provenance or repatriation claim.

13.10 Reasoned verdict scaffolds

- **Safeguarding demand:** "Safeguarding is a present need not because heritage is old but because the specific pressures on it - visitor load, urban encroachment, climate action on fabric and the failure of transmission in living traditions - are current and measurable, and each requires a different instrument."
- **UNESCO evaluation:** "World Heritage status is best judged as a conditional obligation with reputational leverage: it attracts attention, funding and visitors, and it simultaneously raises the standard against which failure is measured - India's own Danger-List entries and removals prove both halves."
- **Institutional demand:** "India does not lack heritage institutions; it lacks the alignment of instrument, capacity and community consent, and the credible reform agenda is about that alignment rather than about new bodies."

13.11 Factual-risk and dynamic-status controls

- ANALYSIS: **Every count in this file is dynamic.** 44 WHS, 16 ICH, 14 MoW, 3,679 ASI monuments and 658 GI goods each carry a verification date (21 July 2026 for the first four; July 2025 for GI). WRONG: Never present any of them as today's figure without re-verification; FACT: always cite the source and the access date.
- FACT: **Stable facts safe to cite without re-verification:** inscription years (1983, 1984, 1986, 1987, 1989, 1993, 2004, 2008, **2016**, 2018, **2021**, 2023, 2024, 2025), statute years (1958, 1972, 1999), institution founding years (1861, 1952, 1954), constitutional articles, and the criteria numbers for a named property. FACT: The dated ledger in **§13.8A** is the single place these years are recorded together.
- WRONG: **Do not turn §13.8A's ledger into a total.** It lists inscriptions from **2016 to 2025 only**; India's running total is dynamic and lives in §8 with its verification date.
- ANALYSIS: **Serial-property component names are examinable:** the three Hoysala temples (Channakeshava/Belur, Hoysaleswara/Halebidu, Keshava/ Somanathapura) and the **Maratha** forts. ANALYSIS: Book-versus-UNESCO naming variation for the Somanathapura temple is recorded in §13.8A and must not be silently resolved.
- WRONG: **Do not confuse an extension year with a first inscription:** the

Great Living Chola Temples are **1987, extended 2004**.

- **WRONG: Do not admit Tentative-List entries** - Aihole, Badami, the Thousand

Pillar Temple, Warangal Fort and the Kakatiya Kala Thoranam - into the inscribed ledger; **Pattadakal (1987)** is the inscribed member of the Aihole-Badami-Pattadakal grouping.

- **WRONG:** Do not state that a specific object has been repatriated without a dated official source naming the object, the receiving institution and its provenance.

- **WRONG:** Do not treat Tentative List status as inscription.

- **WRONG:** Do not equate AMASR prohibited/regulated areas with UNESCO buffer zones.

- **WRONG:** Do not invent conservation budgets, staff numbers, visitor figures or project names.

- **ANALYSIS:** "Latest inclusion" questions are **date-bound**: the 2024 Prelims

question was correct for Garba at that time and Deepavali's 2025 inscription changes the live answer - always read the question's date. **FACT: §13.8B** now makes both answers derivable from a dated element ledger rather than from the running total.

- **WRONG: Do not turn §13.8B's ICH ledger into a stale total.** It lists **16**

elements as at **13 August 2026**; the running total lives in §8 with its verification date, and the locally held book's "**15** items as on August 2025" (PDF p. 733) **predates the Deepavali inscription** and must not be carried forward.

- **ANALYSIS: Nowruz is a multinational inscription**, not an India-only element;

FACT: India has no element on the Urgent Safeguarding List and no practice on the Register of Good Safeguarding Practices - both negatives are sourced (PDF pp. 733, 736) and both are examinable.

- **WRONG: Scheme-versus-statute discipline (§13.8C):** do not call ****AMASR**

1958 **or the Antiquities Act 1972 a scheme, and do not call Adopt a Heritage, Adarsh Smarak or the NCF a statute.** **WRONG: Do not say monuments were "handed over" under Adopt a Heritage - adoption covers** visitor amenities, **the monument remains under ASI and AMASR****, and no structural or restorative work passes to the partner.

- **WRONG: PRASHAD and HRIDAY are bounded gaps.** Neither is carried by any

local source and neither was verified officially in this pass; do not state their full forms, ministries, launch years, components or current status (§13.8C).

- **ANALYSIS: **Adopt a Heritage's version, ministry and partner terminology are**

dynamic. **FACT: The locally sourced formulation - Adopt a Heritage / Apni Dharohar, Apni Pehchaan, with Monument Mitras as partner entities - is safe; CURRENT: the 2.0 revamp and the Culture/ASI locus carry the 13 August 2026**** verification date and must be re-verified.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026

- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I

- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	37	Tai-Ahom Moidams, royal burial practices, and UNESCO heritage status	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Tai-Ahom Moidams, royal burial practices, and UNESCO heritage status

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	65	UNESCO World Heritage properties inscribed in 2023 (Shantiniketan, Hoysalas)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- UNESCO World Heritage properties inscribed in 2023 (Shantiniketan, Hoysalas)

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	Prelims GS-I	81	Colonial-era archaeologists associated with Indian excavations	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Colonial-era archaeologists associated with Indian excavations

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - MARATHA LANDSCAPES, SAFEGUARDING PYQ AND FINAL SPINE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Maratha Landscapes, safeguarding PYQ and final spine

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Maratha Landscapes · safeguarding PYQ · final spine · Evidence chain
· Qualified use

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Maratha Military Landscapes current link - Verified heritage
PYQ routes Qualified use: Close with the direct 2018 demand and current UNESCO evidence.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: 983-985 (Law and Culture/constitutional provisions) - the direct spine for
Sections 2-4. ANALYSIS: Extraction limit recorded: the book's own WHS list is presented as a wide
table whose "Declared in / State" columns are truncated in the locally held PDF beyond the first
row, so the dated ledger in §13.8A was not built from that table.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Thesis (§13.2 instrument-fit: protection fails from instrument mismatch,
not from absent law) -> the four-category firewall (§13.4 WHS, ICH, MoW, GI - four instruments,
four bodies, four legal bases) -> named threats with mechanisms (§13.7) -> named instruments
matched to them: AMASR for fabric, the akademis for transmission, NMM/National Archives for
documents, GI for craft names, the NCF for funding and Adopt a Heritage/Monument Mitras for
amenities (§§13.5, 13.8C) -> a dated current anchor (Deepavali's ICH inscription, 10 December the
gap (capacity thesis; the Hall of Nations demolished in 2017 because 20th-century architecture
falls outside the AMASR antiquity threshold, topic 05) -> verdict (§13.10). ANALYSIS: The strongest
single move is the living-heritage point: India has 16 ICH elements and none on the Urgent
Safeguarding List, which shows recognition is running ahead of any demonstrated transmission crisis
- recognition is not safeguarding.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: 728-729). FACT: As of July 2025 (per the book), no Indian site is on
the Danger List. CURRENT: Recent inscription with criteria: UNESCO inscribed Moidams - the Mound-
Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty at Charaideo on 26 July of mound-covered vaults created from the
thirteenth to nineteenth centuries, recognised under criteria (iii) and (iv). WRONG: Moidams are
not ordinary earthen tumuli: UNESCO describes a mound over a hollow vault, with a shrine and
octagonal wall, within a continuing funerary and ancestor-worship landscape. CURRENT: Most recent
property: the Maratha Military Landscapes of India (2025) is India's 44th, a serial inscription.
WRONG: Do not repeat "43rd" without noting the current 44th. CURRENT: Living-practice recognition:
Deepavali (2025) as the 16th Representative List element; Garba of Gujarat (2023); Kutiyattam (2008).
CURRENT: Estate scale: ASI's live Monuments page states it protects and maintains 3,679
centrally protected monuments and archaeological sites (accessed 21 July 2026) - cite the live
figure with its access date. ANALYSIS: Sovereignty rule: inscription confers international
recognition and Convention-based protections; ownership, management and legal jurisdiction remain
with India and its own institutions (ASI/AMASR).

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Four-category firewall?

A. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. B. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. C. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. D. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

Answer: A. Explanation: World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Four-category firewall?

A. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. B. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. C. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. D. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

Answer: B. Explanation: World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four-category firewall?

A. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. B. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. C. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. D. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

Answer: C. Explanation: World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four-category firewall?

A. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. B. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. C. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. D. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies.

Answer: D. Explanation: World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies World Heritage mechanism?

A. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. B. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. C. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. D. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management.

Answer: A. Explanation: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under World Heritage mechanism?

A. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. B. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. C. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. D. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

Answer: B. Explanation: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of World Heritage mechanism?

A. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. B. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. C. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. D. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

Answer: C. Explanation: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about World Heritage mechanism?

A. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. B. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. C. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. D. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

Answer: D. Explanation: World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Intangible heritage mechanism?

A. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. B. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. C. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. D. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Intangible heritage mechanism?

A. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. B. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. C. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. D. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Intangible heritage mechanism?

A. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. B. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. C. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. D. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Intangible heritage mechanism?

A. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. B. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. C. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. D. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Memory of the World mechanism?

A. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. B. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. C. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. D. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

Answer: A. Explanation: Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Memory of the World mechanism?

A. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. B. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. C. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. D. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles.

Answer: B. Explanation: Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Memory of the World mechanism?

A. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. B. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. C. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. D. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.

Answer: C. Explanation: Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Memory of the World mechanism?

A. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. B. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. C. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. D. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management.

Answer: D. Explanation: Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies GI is domestic IP?

A. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. B. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. C. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. D. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under GI is domestic IP?

A. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. B. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. C. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. D. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of GI is domestic IP?

A. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. B. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. C. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. D. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about GI is domestic IP?

A. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. B. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. C. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. D. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies ASI and its statutes?

A. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. B. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. C. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. D. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under ASI and its statutes?

A. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. B. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. C. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. D. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of ASI and its statutes?

A. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. B. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. C. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. D. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about ASI and its statutes?

A. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. B. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. C. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. D. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Akademi mandate map?

A. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. B. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. C. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. D. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Akademi mandate map?

A. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. B. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. C. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. D. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Akademi mandate map?

A. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. B. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. C. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. D. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. The

remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Akademi mandate map?

A. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. B. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. C. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. D. Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Documentary and research institutions?

A. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. B. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. C. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. D. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Documentary and research institutions?

A. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. B. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. C. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. D. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Documentary and research institutions?

A. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. B. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. C. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. D. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Documentary and research institutions?

A. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. B. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. C. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. D. The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNCA, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Constitutional heritage frame?

A. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. B. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. C. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. D. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses.

Answer: A. Explanation: Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Constitutional heritage frame?

A. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. B. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. C. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. D. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

Answer: B. Explanation: Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Constitutional heritage frame?

A. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. B. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. C. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. D. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

Answer: C. Explanation: Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Constitutional heritage frame?

A. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. B. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). C. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. D. Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage.

Answer: D. Explanation: Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies AMASR zone firewall?

A. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. B. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. C. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. D. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

Answer: A. Explanation: The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under AMASR zone firewall?

A. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. B. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. C. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. D. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

Answer: B. Explanation: The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of AMASR zone firewall?

A. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). B. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. C. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. D. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

Answer: C. Explanation: The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about AMASR zone firewall?

A. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). B. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. C. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. D. The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

Answer: D. Explanation: The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Threat-to-instrument matching?

A. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. B. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. C. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. D. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

Answer: A. Explanation: Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Threat-to-instrument matching?

A. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. B. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. C. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). D. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

Answer: B. Explanation: Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Threat-to-instrument matching?

A. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. B. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). C. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. D. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

Answer: C. Explanation: Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Threat-to-instrument matching?

A. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. B. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. C. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). D. Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses.

Answer: D. Explanation: Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Conservation and restoration?

A. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. B. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. C. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. D. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

Answer: A. Explanation: Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Conservation and restoration?

A. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. B. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. C. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). D. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

Answer: B. Explanation: Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Conservation and restoration?

A. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). B. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. C. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. D. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

Answer: C. Explanation: Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Conservation and restoration?

A. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. B. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. C. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. D. Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks.

Answer: D. Explanation: Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Community rights in living sites?

A. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. B. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). C. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. D. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

Answer: A. Explanation: Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Community rights in living sites?

A. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. B. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. C. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. D. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

Answer: B. Explanation: Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Community rights in living sites?

A. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. B. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. C. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. D. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

Answer: C. Explanation: Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Community rights in living sites?

A. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. B. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. C. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. D. Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

Answer: D. Explanation: Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Danger List conditionality?

A. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. B. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. C. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). D. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

Answer: A. Explanation: Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Danger List conditionality?

A. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. B. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. C. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. D. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

Answer: B. Explanation: Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Danger List conditionality?

A. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. B. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. C. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. D. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.

Answer: C. Explanation: Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Danger List conditionality?

A. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. B. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. C. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. D. Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.

Answer: D. Explanation: Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Moidams evidence?

A. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). B. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. C. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. D. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

Answer: A. Explanation: Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Moidams evidence?

A. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. B. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). C. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. D. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

Answer: B. Explanation: Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Moidams evidence?

A. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. B. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. C. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). D. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.

Answer: C. Explanation: Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Moidams evidence?

A. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. B. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. C. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. D. Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).

Answer: D. Explanation: Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv). The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Recent World Heritage ledger?

A. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. B. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. C. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. D. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Recent World Heritage ledger?

A. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. B. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. C. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. D. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Recent World Heritage ledger?

A. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. B. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. C. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. D. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Recent World Heritage ledger?

A. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. B. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. C. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. D. Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Intangible heritage ledger?

A. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. B. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. C. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. D. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

Answer: A. Explanation: The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Intangible heritage ledger?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. B. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. C. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. D. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies.

Answer: B. Explanation: The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Intangible heritage ledger?

A. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. B. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. C. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. D. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Intangible heritage ledger?

A. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. B. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. C. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. D. The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.

Answer: D. Explanation: The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Schemes, funds and statutes?

A. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. B. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. C. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. D. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.

Answer: A. Explanation: Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Schemes, funds and statutes?

A. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. B. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. C. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. D. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

Answer: B. Explanation: Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are

statutes; none may be substituted for another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Schemes, funds and statutes?

A. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. B. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. C. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. D. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

Answer: C. Explanation: Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Schemes, funds and statutes?

A. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. B. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. C. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. D. Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

Answer: D. Explanation: Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Maratha Military Landscapes current link?

A. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. B. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. C. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. D. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

Answer: A. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Maratha Military Landscapes current link?

A. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. B. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. C. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. D. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

Answer: B. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Maratha Military Landscapes current link?

A. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. B. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. C. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. D. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

Answer: C. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Maratha Military Landscapes current link?

A. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. B. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. C. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. D. UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.

Answer: D. Explanation: UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified heritage PYQ routes?

A. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. B. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty. C. World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies. D. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.

Answer: A. Explanation: The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified heritage PYQ routes?

A. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. B. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. C. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. D. World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.

Answer: B. Explanation: The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified heritage PYQ routes?

A. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. B. The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission. C. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. D. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

Answer: C. Explanation: The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified heritage PYQ routes?

A. The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities. B. Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management. C. A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark. D. The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

The verified direct Mains route is 2018 GS-I on safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need. The objective routes are 2023 colonial archaeologists, 2024 the 2023 inscriptions of Santiniketan and the Hoysala ensembles, and provisional 2026 Moidams; objective answer letters are not inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests heritage institutions or UNESCO categories as a stand-alone topic. This topic is the **verification layer** for every other topic's current- status claim (e.g. topic 03's Khajuraho 1986 inscription, topic 03's Great Living Chola Temples 1987/2004, topic 09's Garba 2023 ICH inscription).

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	37	Tai-Ahom Moidams, royal burial practices, and UNESCO heritage status	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Tai-Ahom Moidams, royal burial practices, and UNESCO heritage status

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	65	UNESCO World Heritage properties inscribed in 2023 (Shantiniketan, Hoysalas)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- UNESCO World Heritage properties inscribed in 2023 (Shantiniketan, Hoysalas)

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	Prelims GS-I	81	Colonial-era archaeologists associated with Indian excavations	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Colonial-era archaeologists associated with Indian excavations

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

8. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests this topic. As the folder's capstone, this file's benefit-versus-trade-off method (Section 3) should close **any** Mains answer in this folder that reaches a UNESCO-status point (e.g. topic 03's Khajuraho/Chola answers, topic 09's Garba reference) - replacing a generic "this shows India's rich heritage" conclusion with a specific, source-grounded current-status-plus-trade-off closing line.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-I	1	Safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-I

Demand: Safeguarding the Indian art heritage is the need of the moment. Discuss. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified routed direct Mains demand; Core ownership supersedes the legacy Advanced pointer.

Model solution: Define safeguarding as threat-to-instrument matching. Use the WHS-ICH-MoW-GI firewall, then name ASI and AMASR for monuments, NMM or Archives for documents, academies for living arts and GI for names. Add visitor, climate, illicit-trade and transmission pressures, one dated property or practice, the capacity and community limit, and a verdict that recognition begins rather than completes protection.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish World Heritage, ICH, Memory of the World and GI. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The four-category firewall matches tangible property, living practice, documentary record and origin-linked product name to four different instruments and institutions.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- World Heritage, Intangible Cultural Heritage, Memory of the World and Geographical Indications are four non-interchangeable systems with different objects, instruments and granting bodies.
- World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.
- The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.
- Memory of the World concerns documentary heritage such as manuscripts and archives, where custody, cataloguing, conservation and digitisation remain distinct from site management.
- A Geographical Indication is origin-linked intellectual property under India's GI Act and GI Registry, not a UNESCO programme or general heritage-quality mark.

Qualified conclusion: The four-category firewall matches tangible property, living practice, documentary record and origin-linked product name to four different instruments and institutions.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the constitutional and statutory architecture of heritage protection in India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Articles 29, 49 and 51A(f) supply the constitutional frame while AMASR and antiquities law enable domain-specific protection through ASI.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.
- Article 29 protects community language, script and culture; Article 49 directs State protection against spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export; Article 51A(f) places a citizen duty to value and preserve composite heritage.
- The generally prohibited first 100 metres and regulated next 200 metres around a centrally protected monument arise from Indian statute and are not UNESCO buffer zones mapped through nomination and management documents.

Qualified conclusion: Articles 29, 49 and 51A(f) supply the constitutional frame while AMASR and antiquities law enable domain-specific protection through ASI.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Discuss safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Current damage mechanisms require instrument-fit: monument law for fabric, archives for documents, academies for transmission, GI for names, funds for finance and community consent for living sites.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Visitor load, urban construction, climate, disaster, material loss, illicit trade and transmission failure damage heritage through different mechanisms and require different legal, technical, archival or livelihood responses.
- Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.
- The direct routed Mains demand is 2018 safeguarding Indian art heritage; objective routes cover 2023 archaeologists, 2024 Santiniketan-Hoysalas and provisional 2026 Moidams, with no answer letter inferred.

Qualified conclusion: Current damage mechanisms require instrument-fit: monument law for fabric, archives for documents, academies for transmission, GI for names, funds for finance and community consent for living sites.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Compare conservation and restoration and assess the role of community rights. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Minimum intervention protects evidentiary fabric, while restoration selects a past and living use adds access, ritual and livelihood claims that technical conservation must negotiate.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Conservation stabilises and retains fabric through minimum documented intervention, while restoration returns an object to a selected earlier state and therefore raises greater authenticity and reversibility risks.
- Active worship, ancestor practice, access and livelihood are conservation variables at sites such as Matangeshvara and Moidams; fabric protection cannot presume that a heritage place is socially empty.

Qualified conclusion: Minimum intervention protects evidentiary fabric, while restoration selects a past and living use adds access, ritual and livelihood claims that technical conservation must negotiate.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate UNESCO recognition as a tool of heritage conservation. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: International recognition creates leverage, duties and visibility but also visitor pressure, conditional monitoring and authenticity trade-offs that domestic institutions must manage.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- World Heritage properties are inscribed under the 1972 Convention for cultural, natural or mixed outstanding universal value by the World Heritage Committee with advisory bodies; inscription is an obligation, not a transfer of sovereignty.
- The 2003 Convention covers living practices, expressions, knowledge and skills through the Representative List, Urgent Safeguarding List and Register of Good Safeguarding Practices; recognition alone does not ensure transmission.
- Manas and Hampi were once on the List of World Heritage in Danger and were later removed after improvement, proving that inscription remains conditional on continuing management.
- Moidams at Charaideo are Tai-Ahom mound-covered royal burial vaults with shrine and octagonal enclosure in a continuing funerary landscape, inscribed in 2024 under criteria (iii) and (iv).
- UNESCO's official property page describes twelve forts, mostly in Maharashtra with one in Tamil Nadu, built, adapted or expanded from the late seventeenth to early nineteenth centuries as a strategic defence network.

Qualified conclusion: International recognition creates leverage, duties and visibility but also visitor pressure, conditional monitoring and authenticity trade-offs that domestic institutions must manage.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess India's heritage institutions through mandate, capacity and coordination. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: India has specialised bodies and instruments; the core challenge is matching mandate and threat while maintaining dated status discipline, documentation and public participation.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Archaeological Survey of India was established in 1861 under Alexander Cunningham and functions through the AMASR Act, 1958 and Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972 for monuments, archaeology and antiquities.
- Sahitya Akademi serves literature, Sangeet Natak Akademi performing arts and Lalit Kala Akademi fine arts; founding dates and programmes do not make their mandates interchangeable.
- The National Mission for Manuscripts, National Archives, IGNC, NMMA, Anthropological Survey, Asiatic Society, ICCR and CCRT perform different documentation, custody, research, cultural-relations and training roles.
- Nalanda, Mumbai's Victorian Gothic and Art Deco ensembles, Dholavira, Ramappa, Santiniketan, the Hoysala ensembles, Moidams and the Maratha Military Landscapes form a dated 2016-2025 ledger; it is not India's complete list.
- The dated Indian ICH ledger runs from 2008 elements through Deepavali in 2025, includes the multinational Nowruz entry, and must keep inscription year separate from any changing total or latest-item question.
- Adopt a Heritage and Adarsh Smarak are executive amenity or participation schemes, the National Culture Fund is a funding mechanism, and AMASR and the Antiquities Act are statutes; none may be substituted for another.

Qualified conclusion: India has specialised bodies and instruments; the core challenge is matching mandate and threat while maintaining dated status discipline, documentation and public participation.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Indian Art & Culture | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-I. **Core area:** UNESCO criteria and management trade-offs; conservation ethics; repatriation/provenance discipline; digitisation; institutional and policy trade-offs across every topic in this folder. **Grounded in:** Nitin Singhania, *Indian Art and Culture*, PDF pp. 722-738, 955-971, 983-992; 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 4-5, 9; audited UPSC Mains 2024-2025 GS Paper I (no direct question - capstone role); official UNESCO WHC/ICH/Memory of the World and PIB pages (verified 21 July 2026). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap. *Companion:* basic/14_Heritage-Conservation-Institutions-and-UNESCO.md.

1. Analytical question and thesis

Question: What trade-offs does UNESCO/institutional heritage recognition actually involve, and how should a Mains answer handle dynamic heritage figures (WHS/ICH counts, GI totals, protected-monument numbers) responsibly across an entire essay spanning multiple topics in this folder? **Thesis:** ANALYSIS: Heritage recognition is never a cost-free "benefit only" outcome - inscription brings international attention and funding (Section 3) but also visitor-pressure, conservation-cost and authenticity/integrity trade-offs (most visible at high-footfall sites like Khajuraho and Hampi, topic 03) - and because every count this folder cites (WHS, ICH, GI, protected monuments) changes over time, a disciplined advanced answer must state its **source and access date** for every such figure rather than treating any single number as permanently fixed.

2. Advanced vocabulary

Term	Precise meaning
FACT: World Heritage Committee's Danger-List mechanism	A structural safeguard: sites deemed inadequately protected/managed can be moved to the List of World Heritage in Danger, and can in principle be delisted entirely if conditions do not improve (<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 728-729) - this is a conditional , not permanent, status once inscribed.
ANALYSIS: Conservation-versus-access trade-off	UNESCO inscription's tourism/economic benefit (Section 3 below) directly increases visitor footfall, which can stress open, unenclosed monuments (e.g. Khajuraho's platforms without boundary walls, topic 03) - an advanced answer should name this trade-off explicitly rather than treating inscription as an unqualified positive.
FACT: Repatriation discipline	This folder's rule (from 00_Master-Framework.md) that no repatriation claim should be made without a dated official source naming the object, receiving institution and provenance - directly relevant whenever a Mains answer risks citing an unverified "artefact returned to India" claim.
ANALYSIS: Institutional mandate precision	ASI (monuments/archaeology), SNA (performing arts), LKA (visual arts), Sahitya Akademi (literature), National Archives (documentary records), Asiatic Society (research/library) have distinct primary mandates, though projects can overlap.
FACT: Domestic-zone vs. UNESCO-buffer distinction	AMASR's prohibited/regulated areas around centrally protected monuments arise from Indian law; a WH property buffer zone is mapped through UNESCO nomination/management documents. Never substitute one boundary for the other.

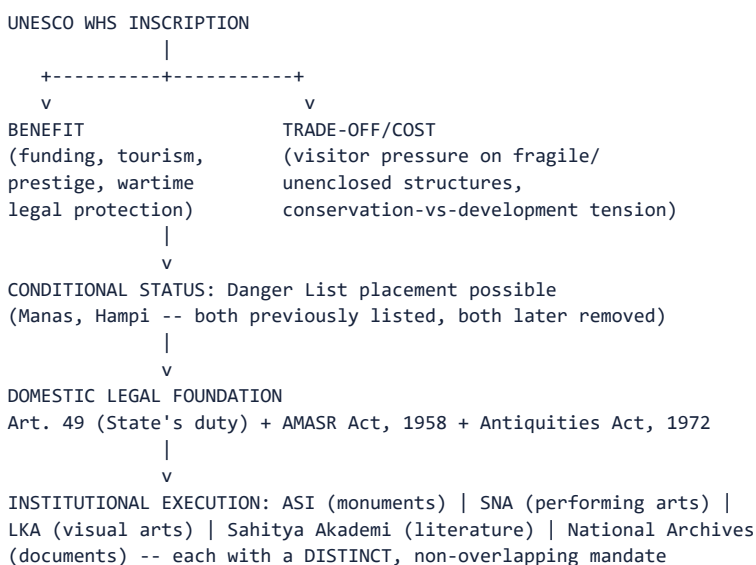
3. Comparative framework

Benefit of WHS status	Corresponding trade-off/cost	Where documented
FACT: International attention/preservation funding	Increased visitor footfall stressing fragile/unenclosed structures	<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 728 (benefits list); topic 03 (Khajuraho's unenclosed platforms)
FACT: Tourism-driven economic benefit	Conservation-versus-commercial-development tension at heritage sites	<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 728; Economy folder (tourism economics, out of this file's scope)
FACT: Geneva Convention wartime protection	Protection is legal/normative, not a guarantee against neglect or slow deterioration absent active management	<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF pp. 725-726
FACT: Global project-management resource access	Requires State Party (India) institutional capacity (ASI/AMASR) to actually absorb and apply that access	<i>Nitin...pdf</i> , PDF p. 728

4. Evidence, form and interpretation

FACT: The book's own list of WHS "benefits" (international attention, tourism/economic benefit, UNESCO restoration funding, UN partnership prestige, global project-management access, partnership facilitation, Geneva Convention wartime protection, *Nitin...pdf*, PDF p. 728) is presented uncritically as a benefits list; an advanced answer should supply the corresponding cost/trade-off for each benefit (Section 3) to avoid a one-sided "UNESCO listing is purely good" argument - this is the same critical-reading discipline this folder applies elsewhere (e.g. questioning whether "synthesis" claims in topic 13 admit their limits). ANALYSIS: Applying the conditional-status point (Section 2) concretely: Manas Wildlife Sanctuary and the Group of Monuments at Hampi were **both** previously placed on the Danger List and **both** were subsequently removed after documented conservation improvement (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 728-729) - this is directly usable evidence that WHS status is a managed, conditional relationship between India and UNESCO, not a one-time award. FACT: The constitutional layer (Articles 29, 49, 51A(f)) supplies the **domestic legal foundation** beneath every UNESCO-level claim: Article 49's explicit language - protecting monuments "from spoliation, disfigurement, destruction, removal, disposal or export" (*Nitin...pdf*, PDF p. 984) - is the direct textual basis for ASI's AMASR-Act mandate and for treating illicit export/removal as a constitutional as well as statutory concern.

5. Visual synthesis table



6. Direct-book source spine

FACT: *Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 725-729 (WHS criteria, legal status, benefits, Danger List and the Manas/Hampi removal case), PDF pp. 956-967 (institutional mandates), PDF pp. 984-985 (Articles 29, 49, 51A(f)).

7. CURRENT: Dated official anchor

- CURRENT: UNESCO inscribed ****Moidams - the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom**

Dynasty **at Charaideo** on 26 July 2024**, making it India's 43rd World Heritage property. UNESCO criteria (iii) and (iv) recognise six centuries of Tai-Ahom royal funerary custom and the necropolis as an outstanding expression of its associated cosmology. The property page also identifies rainfall, erosion and vegetation growth as management pressures - a precise conservation hook, not merely a changing count.

- CURRENT: As verified on 21 July 2026, India holds 44 WH properties; Maratha

Military Landscapes (2025) is the latest. India has 16 Representative List ICH elements after Deepavali (2025), and 14 Memory of the World International Register inscriptions after the Bhagavadgita and Natyashastra manuscript additions (2025). Re-check after each annual cycle.

- CURRENT: ASI's live Monuments page states that it protects and maintains

3,679 centrally protected monuments and archaeological sites (accessed 21 July 2026); cite the live figure with its access date.

8. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests this topic. As the folder's capstone, this file's benefit-versus-trade-off method (Section 3) should close **any** Mains answer in this folder that reaches a UNESCO-status point (e.g. topic 03's Khajuraho/Chola answers, topic 09's Garba reference) - replacing a generic "this shows India's rich heritage" conclusion with a specific, source-grounded current-status-plus-trade-off closing line.

9. WRONG: Attribution, chronology and numeric traps

- WRONG: Presenting UNESCO WHS/ICH inscription as a purely beneficial, cost-free status. -> Name the corresponding conservation/visitor-pressure trade-off (Section 3) for a complete answer.

- WRONG: Treating WHS status as permanent and unconditional once granted. ->

The Danger List mechanism, and the Manas/Hampi case specifically, show status is actively managed and conditional on continued protection.

- WRONG: Treating the Moidams as only an Ahom political-history example. ->

Their mound-vault-shrine form, sacred landscape and conservation pressures make them a distinct funerary-architecture and heritage-management case; detailed Ahom administration remains in Medieval History topic 08.

- WRONG: Assuming any specific artefact has been repatriated to India without a dated official source naming the object, institution and provenance. -> Apply the repatriation discipline (Section 2) strictly.

- WRONG: Treating SNA, LKA, Sahitya Akademi, ASI and the National Archives as interchangeable "cultural bodies." -> Each has a precise, distinct primary mandate; conflating them is a specific, avoidable error.

- WRONG: Treating the AMASR 100 m/200 m spatial regime as UNESCO's buffer-zone rule. -> Domestic statutory control and World Heritage management mapping are different layers that must be analysed together.

10. Mains answer frameworks

Central thesis: Heritage recognition and institutional architecture should be argued through a paired benefit-and-trade-off structure, with every dynamic figure (WHS/ICH/GI/protected-monument counts) cited with its specific source and access date, and with institutional mandates named precisely rather than generically.

1. **Name the precise heritage category and its governing instrument** before citing any count.

2. **Pair every benefit claim with its corresponding trade-off** (Section 3).
3. for a complete, non-one-sided answer.

3. **Use the Manas/Hampi Danger-List-and-removal case** as concrete evidence that WHS status is conditional and actively managed.

4. **Cite the constitutional foundation** (Articles 29, 49, 51A(f)) as the domestic legal layer beneath any UNESCO-level claim.

5. **Close with a dated, source-specific current figure** rather than an undated round number, explicitly naming the source and access date.

11. Subject boundaries

- WRONG: **Polity owns** the full constitutional/fundamental-rights doctrine and case law on Articles 29, 49 and 51A(f).

- WRONG: **Economy owns** heritage tourism's economic-sectoral analysis (job creation, revenue, market dynamics) in depth.

- WRONG: **Current Affairs owns** day-to-day event chronology beyond the dated heritage anchors this file verifies.

- FACT: This file is the **cross-cutting verification and closing layer** for every topic (01-13) in this folder.

12. Companion links

- FACT: Foundation companion:

basic/14_Heritage-Conservation-Institutions-and-UNESCO.md.

- FACT: 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 5 and 9 - the current-claim verification protocol and official-source ledger, both fully applied here.

- ANALYSIS: **Cross-links:** all topics 01-13 route their UNESCO/institutional current-status claims through this file; see especially topic 03 (Khajuraho/Chola conservation-tourism trade-off), topic 12 (GI as a distinct, non-UNESCO category).

13. Verification ledger and open cautions

- FACT: Verified against *Nitin...pdf*, PDF pp. 722-738, 955-971 and 983-985

directly and against official pages checked 21 July 2026: India has 44 WH properties after the 2025 Maratha Military Landscapes inscription; Deepavali's 2025 inscription brings India's Representative List total to 16; Bhagavadgita and Natyashastra take the Memory of the World total to 14; ASI's Monuments page states 3,679 centrally protected monuments and archaeological sites.

- FACT: Moidams details verified against UNESCO's property page (checked 21 July 2026): inscription on 26 July 2024; criteria (iii) and (iv); Tai-Ahom royal necropolis at Charaideo; rainfall, erosion and vegetation growth recorded as conservation factors.

- ANALYSIS: The book's GI figure is 658 registered goods as of July 2025. Any later exact total requires a dated GI Registry registered-status extract or identified DPIIT parliamentary reply; do not infer it from the Registry's all-applications display.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018

- **Paper(s):** GS-I

- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-I	1	Safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Safeguarding Indian art heritage as a present need

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

High-yield use: Follow the panels as one topic-specific conceptual atlas: root question, classifications, processes or arguments, comparisons, objections and a final answer-writing spine. This text-native master is separate from both graphical flowchart artifacts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Four-category firewall

WHS -> tangible or mixed property
ICH -> living practice and transmission
MoW -> documentary record
GI -> domestic origin-linked IP

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Conditional-status loop

INSCRIPTION -> recognition and duty
MONITORING -> management scrutiny
DANGER LIST -> corrective pressure
REMOVAL -> improvement can restore status

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Institution mandate map

ASI -> monuments and archaeology
SNA -> performing arts
SAHITYA / LKA -> literature and fine arts
NMM / ARCHIVES -> manuscripts and records

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Constitutional ladder

ARTICLE 29 -> community cultural right
ARTICLE 49 -> State monument duty
ARTICLE 51A(f) -> citizen duty
STATUTES -> operational protection

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Boundary firewall

AMASR 100 m -> generally prohibited
AMASR next 200 m -> regulated
UNESCO BUFFER -> mapped management zone
RULE -> separate legal sources

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Threat-response matrix

VISITOR LOAD -> access management
URBAN / CLIMATE -> regulation and monitoring
DISASTER / DECAY -> documentation and conservation
TRANSMISSION LOSS -> practitioner support

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Conservation-restoration test

CONSERVE -> stabilise existing fabric
RESTORE -> return to chosen earlier state
REVERSIBILITY -> preferred in conservation
AUTHENTICITY -> risk rises with reconstruction

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Living-site balance

ACTIVE WORSHIP? -> protect access
LIVELIHOOD? -> assess displacement
FRAGILE FABRIC? -> regulate use
VERDICT -> negotiate, do not empty the site

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Moidams form map

VAULT -> hollow royal burial chamber
MOUND -> earth-covered form
SHRINE + WALL -> ritual enclosure
LANDSCAPE -> continuing ancestor practice

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Recent WH ledger

2016 -> Nalanda
2021 -> Dholavira and Ramappa
2023 -> Santiniketan and Hoysalas
2024 / 2025 -> Moidams and Maratha forts

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Scheme-statute firewall

AMASR / ANTIQUITIES -> statutes
ADOPT A HERITAGE -> amenities partnership
ADARSH SMARAK -> visitor amenities
NCF -> funding mechanism

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Heritage answer spine

DIAGNOSE -> category and threat
MATCH -> law, body, fund or scheme
EVIDENCE -> named site or practice
QUALIFY -> capacity, community and dynamic status